Case study 8: Toy box

National 5 · Practical Woodworking · Answers and marking guidance

Award one mark per correct point unless stated. Other valid answers should be credited. Sketches can gain full marks if they show enough detail.

1 (a) Describe one advantage of a corner rebate joint over a butt joint. (1 mark)

- Larger glue area so it is stronger
- Hides some of the end grain
- Locates the parts so assembly is easier

Any 1 point.

1 (b) Describe the stages in cutting the rebate by hand. (2 marks)

- Gauge the depth and width of the rebate with a marking gauge from the face side and the end
- Saw across with a tenon saw and remove waste with a chisel (or cut with a rebate plane), then test the fit

2 (a) Name a joint suitable for the corners of a panelled lid. (1 mark)

- Haunched mortise and tenon
- Bridle / halving (with groove)

Any 1 point.

2 (b) Name the plane used to cut the groove for the panel. (1 mark)

- Plough plane

3 Describe two features of the finish or construction that make it safe for children. (2 marks)

- Non-toxic, child-safe finish (e.g. water-based, toy-safe)
- All edges and corners rounded and sanded smooth to prevent cuts and splinters
- Lid stays/safety hinges so it can't slam on fingers

Any 2 points.

4 Give two reasons why pine is a suitable material for the toy box. (2 marks)

- Cheap and readily available
- Light in weight / easy to work
- Softwood grows quickly, so it is more sustainable

Any 2 points.

5 State the purpose of a corner block inside the box. (1 mark)

- Strengthens the corner joint / adds glue area

Total: 10 marks